



960 CE

SONG DYNASTY FOUNDED

Zhao Kuangyin, a general of the Later Zhou dynasty in northern China, seized the capital Kaifeng and declared himself Emperor Taizu of the Song dynasty. Over next 20 years he conquered the rest of China, reunifying it after the chaotic Five Dynasties and Ten Kingdom period. His promotion of education, scientific academies, and a rigorous civil service examination strengthened China's central bureaucracy.

◀ *Along the River During the Qingming Festival*, one of the most famous Chinese paintings, depicts life in the Song capital Kaifeng (Bianjing)

961 CE Nicephorus Phocas, Byzantine emperor, takes Crete from the Arabs

c. 965 CE King Harald Bluetooth of Denmark converts to Christianity

969 CE

962 CE German king Otto I is crowned Holy Roman Emperor in Rome

969 CE The Fatimids conquer Egypt and transfer their caliphate there

955 CE

OTTO I DEFEATS THE MAGYARS

At the Battle of Lechfeld, the heavy cavalry of the German king Otto I routed a force of Magyar horseman. The death of most of the Magyar leaders ended their raids westward. In 962 CE, Otto was crowned Holy Roman Emperor by Pope John XII.

Imperial Crown of Otto I



930-1789 HISTORY OF PARLIAMENTS

The Middle Ages saw the establishment of assemblies of commoners that asserted their rights against monarchs and gradually evolved into today's democratic parliaments.



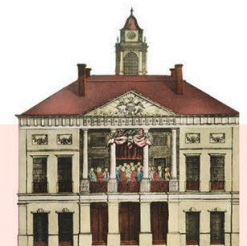
930 CE The Althing, the world's first parliament, is established in Viking-ruled Iceland, meeting annually to decide on laws.



1188 The Cortes of León, the first parliamentary body in mainland Europe, meets, including nobles, merchants, and townsmen.



1295 The English Model Parliament is called by Edward I: it includes nobles and two representatives from each city and borough.



1789 The First US Congress meets in New York City; representatives from the 13 states are elected by popular vote.